

CLAIRE — Technique Candidates

Run date: 2026-05-31

Cross-platform workflow techniques surfaced this cycle. Test manually before considering any configuration change.

1. Plan-Before-Execute Prompting [MEDIUM]

Ask the AI to explicitly list what the output needs to accomplish or what criteria it should meet before producing the output. For example: 'Before writing, list the 4 things this email needs to do well. Then write it.' This forces a planning step that improves output quality by aligning the AI's goals with the user's intent before generation begins.

Source signal: [/r/ClaudeAI/comments/1tg52af/5_claude_patterns_that_helped_nontechnical_users/](#)

Test: Before your next writing or analysis request, prepend 'First list [N] things this response needs to do well, then produce it.' and compare the result to a direct request.

2. Examples Over Adjectives [MEDIUM]

Instead of describing desired tone or style with adjectives (e.g. 'professional,' 'friendly,' 'concise'), paste in concrete examples of text that has the quality you want. The AI infers the style from examples rather than interpreting vague descriptors, producing more accurate outputs.

Source signal: [/r/ClaudeAI/comments/1tg52af/5_claude_patterns_that_helped_nontechnical_users/](#)

Test: Replace style adjectives in your next prompt with one or two pasted examples of text you want the output to resemble, then compare the result to your adjective-based approach.

3. Pre-Task Context Elicitation [MEDIUM]

Before asking the AI to perform a task, first ask it what information it would need to do the task well. This surfaces missing context the user may not have thought to provide, reducing incomplete or generic outputs.

Source signal: [/r/ClaudeAI/comments/1tg52af/5_claude_patterns_that_helped_nontechnical_users/](#)

Test: On your next complex request, first ask 'What would you need to see or know to do this task well?' and provide what it requests before issuing the main task prompt.

4. Explicit Non-Invention Instruction [MEDIUM]

Include an explicit instruction telling the AI not to invent, assume, or fabricate information, and to ask for clarification when something is unknown. Phrased as 'don't assume anything and always ask for clarification rather than inventing details.' This is noted as effective across AI tools when accuracy is critical.

Source signal: /r/VAClaims/comments/1tk082g/steal_my_claude_prompt/

Test: Add 'Do not assume or invent any information; if you are uncertain about a detail, ask me for clarification instead' to your next high-stakes prompt and observe whether hallucinations or unsupported claims decrease.

Total technique candidates this cycle: 4